

vision**2**learn

Part of  Knowledgepool

IT User Skills Level 2

Hints
and
Tips

Spreadsheet
Unit



Contents

Section 1 – Creating and managing a spreadsheet	4
Section 2 – Analysing data A	5
Section 3 – Analysing data B	6
Section 4 – Formatting and presenting data	7
Section 5 – Charts and graphs	8
Section 6 – Formatting and presenting data	9
Section 7 – Improving productivity and efficiency	10

Hints and Tips Spreadsheet Unit

The information in this guide will be helpful to you when you are ready to complete your assessment for the following unit:

Unit 68: Spreadsheet Software Level 2

Unit 1: Improving Productivity Using IT Level 2

Please note: As the IT course is predominately practical not all questions have needed to be included in this guide. General guidance with some specific questions have been included where necessary.

The videos and practice documents that you have been provided throughout the course are an invaluable resource which have been designed to allow you to develop your skills and understanding of the tools and features of software.

Please try to make full use of these and if you are unsure of anything don't hesitate to ask your tutor for assistance.

Enjoy your course.

Section 1 – Creating and managing a spreadsheet

Q2. What types of information might be included in a spreadsheet? List at least 4 types of information.

Remember you covered different types of information in session 1 page 2.

Q3. When you are creating your spreadsheet for this Assessment, what Excel tools / features can you use to make sure that it is structured effectively? Include at least two examples in your answer.

When answering this question think about structural tools that you covered in session 1 page 3.

Q4. Open Excel – you are going to create a spreadsheet about the sales of different fruits. The spreadsheet should contain the following data.

When copying the data into your spreadsheet a good point to note is that there should not be any blank columns or rows within the data.

Section 2 – Analysing data A

In this section you need to add new columns or rows to the existing data to enable you to perform some calculations.

You will need to use various formulas and functions to complete these tasks so if you are unsure of which ones to use, refer back to session 3 for guidance.

You will find it useful to tick off each task as you go which will ensure that you don't miss anything.

Section 3 – Analysing data B

You will need use the spreadsheet file SS2 fruitandveggie_data that you downloaded from the resouces section to complete this task.

- Q2.** Using this spreadsheet to help you, complete the following table by identifying which tools / techniques you would use to meet the requirements. The first task has been completed as an example.

Make you that you check what each tool/technique is used for before making your selections.

Section 4 – Formatting and presenting data

- Q1.** You are going to start to format your spreadsheet. Before you begin, identify at least three techniques that you could use when formatting your spreadsheet. How will this enhance the appearance and meaning of your spreadsheet?

For this question you need to **identify** and also **explain** how each of the formatting tools will enhance the appearance and meaning of the spreadsheet. Make sure that you add the explanation as simply identifying the formatting tools is not sufficient to fulfill the criteria.

Questions 2 to 14.

In this section you are going to apply a range of formatting to the content of your spreadsheet. If you are unsure of any tasks, you should refer back to session 4 for guidance.

When completing the print preview task use the scaling options to assist in fitting all the content on one page.

Section 5 – Charts and graphs

In this section you need to create a chart and then create a link on the Sales data worksheet that will open the chart 1 worksheet.

When creating the chart you need to ensure that you only use the product and total sales data. If you are unsure of how to create a chart using this method please refer to session 5 for guidance and particularly the practice video on page 2.

When creating the hyperlink make sure that you place it on the text in the cell and check that you are linking it to the chart 1 worksheet within the same spreadsheet.

Section 6 – Quality control

- Q2. State two different ways that you could find and correct errors in your spreadsheet formulas.

This question is asking specifically about errors in formulas, not errors in spelling and grammar. If you are unsure of how to find and correct errors please see session 6 pages 1-3.

- Q2. Now check your spreadsheet, remembering to look at all aspects, including text, numerical data, formulas etc. Make corrections as necessary in response to any problems you identify. Write a description of any problems you identified and the corrections you have made in the box below:

For this question it is important to write a description and not bullet point or list any errors that you found.

Section 7 – Improving productivity and efficiency

Answer each question as fully as possible – there are no questions in which the answer is ‘not applicable.’

When the questions ask for benefits/drawbacks or factors – the answer needs to be in plural – so we are looking for more than one of each.

Q1. Use the table below to review the productivity and efficiency of the IT tools that you have used for all the tasks that you have completed during the course. What were the benefits and drawbacks of the IT tools you used? Consider three of the following factors in your answer.

For this question you need to consider and provide a detailed response on how each of the facts that you have selected affected the productivity and efficiency of the work that you have carried out in all three assessments. Try to be as detailed as possible in your response for each of these.

Q2a. For this question you need to provide two solutions you could use to further improve your productivity and efficiency if you were to carry out these tasks again. Describe these solutions in the box below.

For this question, try to think of the various tools and features of the software that will help you to improve your productivity and efficiency in the future. What tools/features are there within the software? Other than the tools within the software are there any things that an organisation could provide that will assist in improving productivity and efficiency?

Q2b. Now put the solutions you identified in Question 2a into practice! Test how they work and describe the outcome in the box below. Which solutions did you test? Did the solutions improve your productivity / efficiency as expected? If not, why not?

For this question it is important that you test both your solutions and then describe the results. Try to be as detailed as possible in your responses.